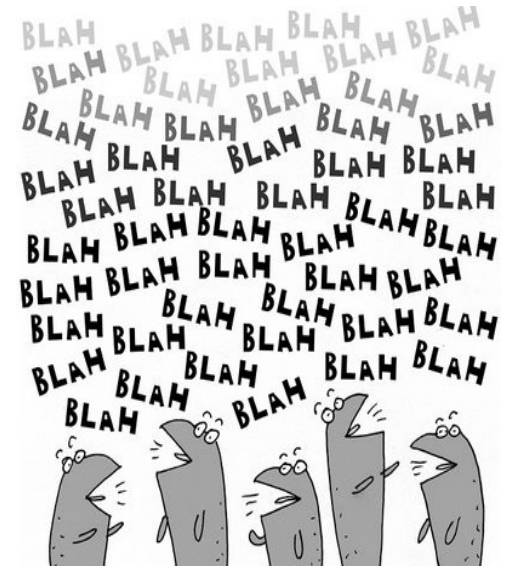


Academic Writing

Lesson 4: Writing Concisely,



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Ways to write concisely



1. Avoid redundant words/expressions
2. Avoid empty phrases
3. Use specific vocabulary, avoiding multiple word constructions (where less wordy ones exist).
4. Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)
5. Avoid continuous constructions
6. Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible)
7. Eliminate obvious/unnecessary information.
8. Use parallel structures
9. Avoid cliches

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“past memories”

“true facts”

“terrible tragedy”

“unexpected surprise”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“~~past~~ memories”

“~~true~~ facts”

“~~terrible~~ tragedy”

“~~unexpected~~ surprise”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“human society”

“future predictions”

“the process of globalisation”

“plummeted dramatically”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“~~human~~ society”

“~~future~~ predictions”

“~~the process of~~ globalisation”

“plummeted ~~dramatically~~”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“The causes of the fall in profitability are given in the following section below.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“The causes of the fall in profitability are given in the following section ~~below~~.”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“The primary reasons for the economic collapse of 2008 were because of a lack of regulation, the availability of too much cheap credit and a lack of transparency.”

A decorative pattern of light gray and white squares, resembling a pixelated or mosaic effect, located at the bottom of the slide.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“The primary reasons for the economic collapse of 2008 were ~~became~~ of a lack of regulation, the availability of too much cheap credit and a lack of transparency.”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

“In the future, the government will have to address these issues and act, if it does not want to see a repetition of the crisis.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

~~In the future~~, the government will have to
address these issues and act, if it does not want
to see a repetition of the crisis.”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid redundant words/expressions

~~In the future,~~ The government will have to address these issues and act, if it does not want to see a repetition of the crisis.”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

As far as I am concerned, discrimination against certain ethnic groups continues to exist for all intents and purposes.



Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

~~As far as I am concerned, discrimination against certain ethnic groups continues to exist for all intents and purposes.~~

Discrimination against certain ethnic groups continues to exist.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

At this point in time, the latest iPad is expensive due to the fact that it has no competition.



Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

~~At this point in time, the latest iPad is expensive due to the fact that it has no competition.~~

The latest iPad is expensive because it has no competition.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

In this day and age, it is clear that young people know more about computers than they know about history.



Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

~~In this day and age~~, it is clear that young people know more about computers than they ~~are~~ about history.

Nowadays, it is clear that young people know more about computers than history.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

Cameras were used for the purpose of identifying criminals.

Cameras were used to identify criminals.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

We will move indoors in the event that it rains.



Ways to write concisely



Avoid empty phrases

We will move indoors in the event that it rains.

We will move indoors if it rains.



Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“However, we are still not in a position to recommend fully the proposed tax rises; more research will need to look very carefully at these issues.”

A decorative pixelated pattern at the bottom of the slide, composed of a grid of squares in various shades of gray and white.

Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“However, we are still not in a position to recommend fully the proposed tax rises; more research will need to **look very carefully at** these issues.”

Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“However, we are still not in a position to recommend fully the proposed tax rises; more research will need to **examine** these issues.”



Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“ ... because the authorities did not allow any form of protesting, critics of the government were forced to ... ”



Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“ ... because the authorities **did not allow** any form of protesting, critics of the government were forced to ... ”



Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“ ... because the authorities **forbade/prohibited** any form of protesting, critics of the government were forced to ... ”

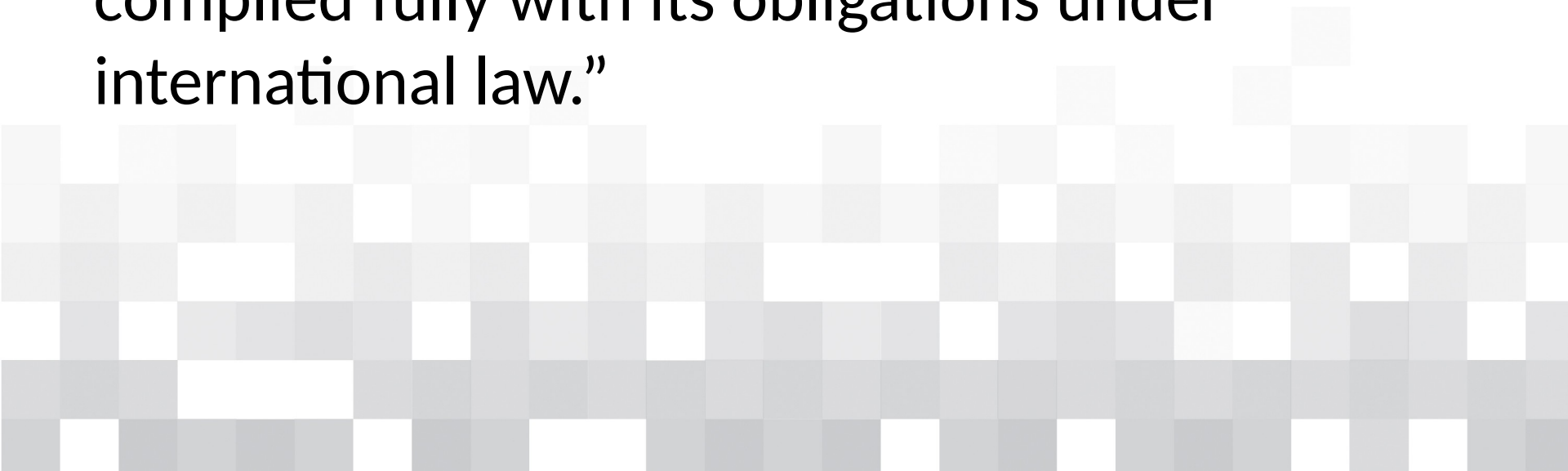


Ways to write concisely



Use specific vocabulary

“The ***current*** Afghani government, ***which will only exist temporarily until a permanent government can be established***, has not complied fully with its obligations under international law.”

A decorative pattern of light gray and white squares, resembling a pixelated or mosaic effect, located at the bottom of the slide.

Ways to write concisely

Use specific vocabulary

“The *interim* Afghani government has not complied fully with its obligations under international law.”

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Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“In a situation in which a class is over-enrolled,
you may request that the teacher register you.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“In a situation in which a class is over-enrolled, you may request that the teacher register you.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“When a class is over-enrolled, you may request that the teacher register you.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“After three days of examining the evidence, the lawyers came to the conclusion that there was no case to answer.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“After three days of examining the evidence, the lawyers ***came to the conclusion*** that there was no case to answer.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“After three days of examining the evidence, the lawyers ***concluded*** that there was no case to answer.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“First of all, there has been very little convincing evidence that the changes have been effective.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“First of all, there has been very little convincing evidence that the changes have been effective.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“First/Firstly, there has been very little convincing evidence that the changes have been effective.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“Over-borrowing was common owing to the fact that cheap credit from newly prosperous China was readily available.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“Over-borrowing was common ***owing to the fact that*** cheap credit from newly prosperous China was readily available.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“Over-borrowing was common ***because*** cheap credit from newly prosperous China was readily available.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“As a result of these new international standards, NGOs have the opportunity to operate in a greatly liberated environment.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“As a result of these new international standards, NGOs have the opportunity to operate in a greatly liberated environment.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“***Due to*** these new international standards, NGOs have the opportunity to operate in a greatly liberated environment.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“As a result of these new international standards, NGOs ***have the opportunity to*** operate in a greatly liberated environment.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“Due to these new international standards, NGOs **can** operate in a greatly liberated environment.”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“In spite of the fact that there were many opportunities throughout 2014, the panel did not pick up on the mistake until January 2015 .”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“In spite of the fact that there were many opportunities throughout 2014, the panel did not pick up on the mistake until January 2015 .”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“**Although** there were many opportunities throughout 2014, the panel did not pick up on the mistake until January 2015 .”



Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

“Despite many opportunities throughout 2014,
the panel did not pick up on the mistake until
January 2015 .”



Ways to write concisely



Avoiding multi-word constructions

While previous studies have demonstrated that home workers produce more work than workers who are based in offices, the LSE study of more than 500 employees shows that on a long term basis, there are no differences between home and office workers.

Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

While previous studies have demonstrated that home workers produce more work than office-based workers, the LSE study of more than 500 employees shows that ***on a long term basis***, there are no differences between home and office workers.

Ways to write concisely



... avoiding multiple word constructions

While previous studies have demonstrated that home workers produce more work than office-based workers, the LSE study of more than 500 employees shows that, ***long term***, there are no differences between home and office workers.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)

“It has been accepted by most economists that, in the long run, open economies achieve more in aggregate than do closed ones, and that relatively open policies contribute significantly to development.”

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Ways to write concisely



Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)

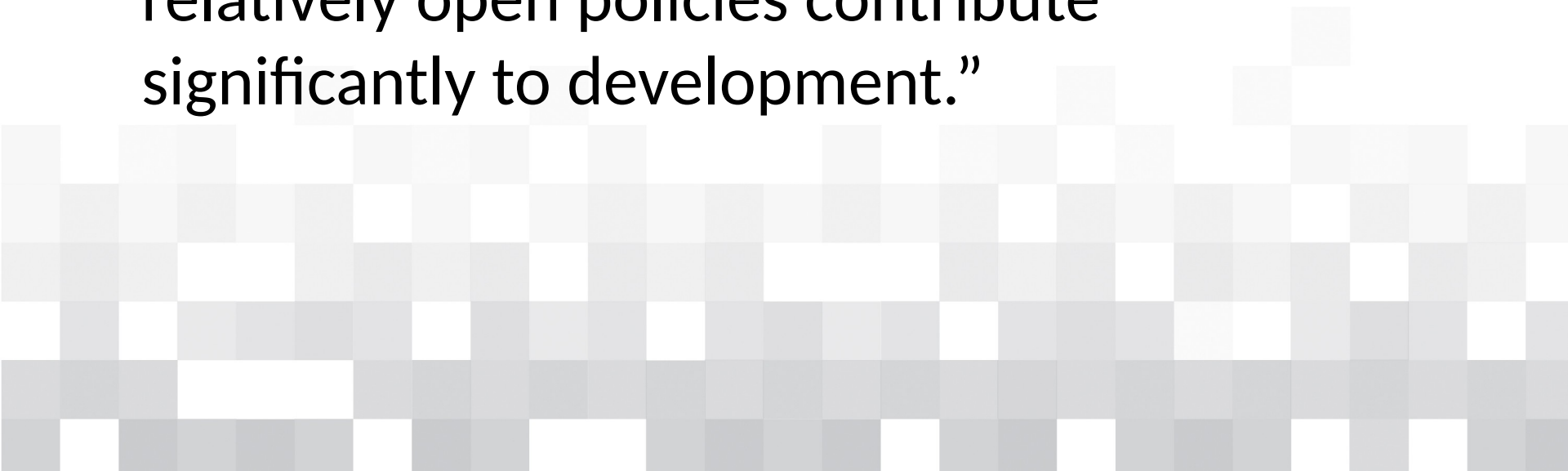
“It has been accepted by most economists
that, in the long run, open economies
achieve more in aggregate than do closed
ones, and that relatively open policies
contribute significantly to development.”

Ways to write concisely



Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)

“Most economists accept that, in the long run, open economies achieve more in aggregate than do closed ones, and that relatively open policies contribute significantly to development.”

A decorative pattern of light gray and white squares, resembling a pixelated or mosaic effect, located at the bottom of the slide.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)

“Three attempts, so far, have been made by Pfizer to acquire AstraZeneca.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)

“Three attempts, so far, have been made by Pfizer to acquire AstraZeneca.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid passive constructions (where appropriate)

“Pfizer has made three attempts, so far, to acquire AstraZeneca.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid continuous constructions

“The government are planning to review the treaty terms.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid continuous constructions

“The government ***are planning to*** review the treaty terms.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid continuous constructions

“The government ***plan to*** review the treaty terms.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid continuous constructions

“Many researchers have been examining these issues.”



Ways to write concisely



Avoid continuous constructions

“Many researchers ***have been examining*** these issues.”



Ways to write concisely

Avoid continuous constructions

“Many researchers ***have examined*** these issues.”



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

While previous studies have demonstrated that home workers produce more work than workers who are based in offices, the LSE study of more than 500 employees shows that on a long term basis, there are no differences between home and office workers.

Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

While previous studies have demonstrated that home workers produce more work than ***workers who are based in offices***, the LSE study of more than 500 employees shows that on a long term basis, there are no differences between home and office workers.

Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

While previous studies have demonstrated that home workers produce more work than ***office-based workers***, the LSE study of more than 500 employees shows that on a long term basis, there are no differences between home and office workers.

Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

“The organisation that should take most culpability is the CBI.”



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

“The organisation ***that should take most culpability*** is the CBI.”



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

“The ***most culpable*** organisation is the CBI.”



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

“An issue that is highly-controversial in UK politics is how MPs receive remuneration.”



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

“An issue ***that is highly-controversial*** in UK politics, is how MPs receive remuneration.”



Ways to write concisely



Use adjectives instead of relative clauses or complements (where possible).

“A ***highly-controversial*** issue in UK politics, is how MPs receive remuneration.”



Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

When will we have the necessary information to make a decision on which candidate to hire for the position?



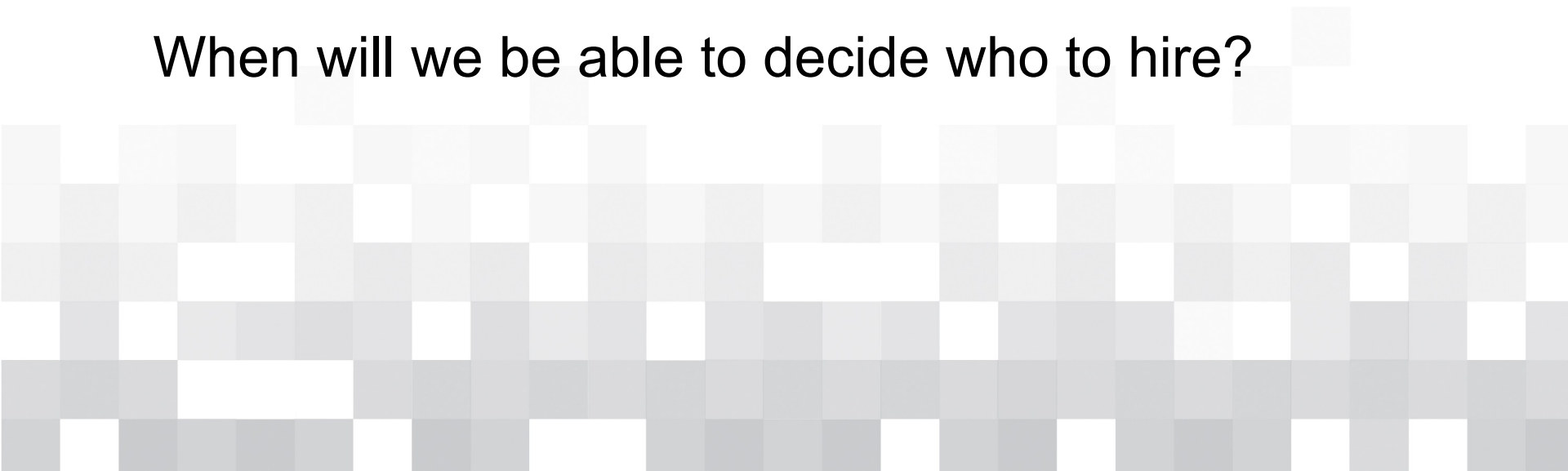
Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

When will we **have the necessary information to make a decision on which candidate to hire for the position?**

When will we be able to decide who to hire?

A decorative pattern of light gray and white squares, resembling a pixelated or mosaic effect, located at the bottom of the slide.

Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

I talked to my supervisor and she informed me that she would approve my vacation request.



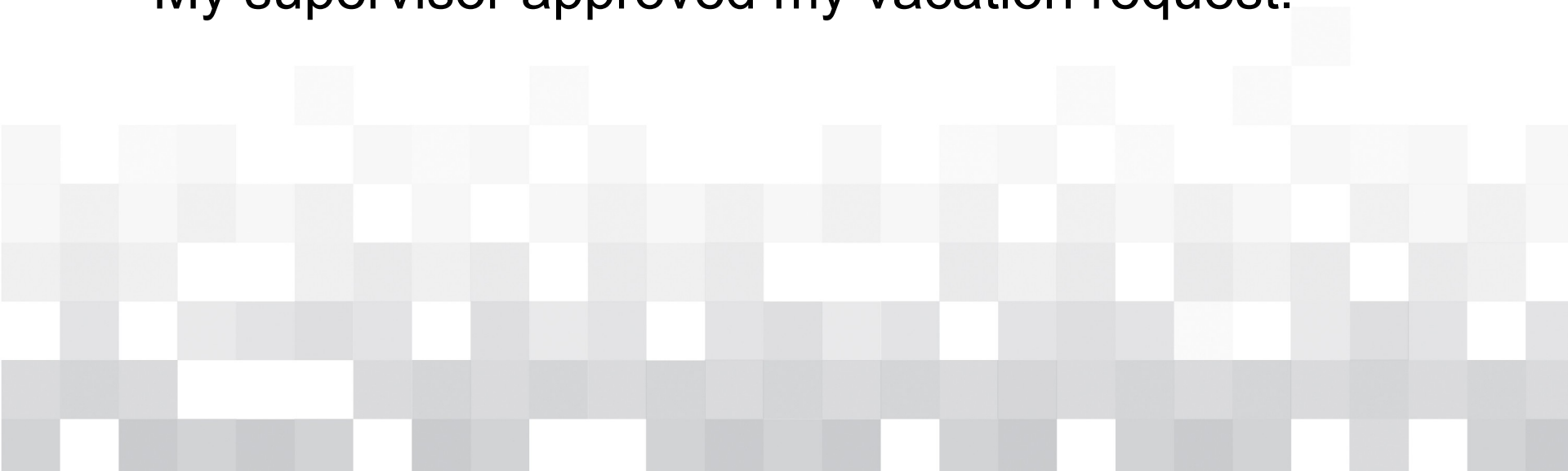
Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

I talked to my supervisor and she informed me that she would approve my vacation request.

My supervisor approved my vacation request.



Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

Finding a job can be really difficult for those who are somewhat inexperienced.



Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

Finding a job can be **really** difficult for **those who are somewhat** inexperienced.

Finding a job can be difficult for **the** inexperienced.



Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

It's a very good idea.



Ways to write concisely



Eliminate Obvious/Unnecessary Information

It's a **very good** idea.

It's a **great** idea.



Ways to write concisely



Use parallel structures

She is professional, courteous and she always comes to work on time.



Ways to write concisely



Use parallel structures

She is professional, courteous and **she always comes to work on time.** (adjective, adjective, independent clause)

She is professional, courteous and punctual.
(adjective, adjective, adjective)

Ways to write concisely



Use parallel structures

We could fill this position now, or someone could be hired next year.



Ways to write concisely



Use parallel structures

We could fill this position now, or someone could be hired next year. (active voice + passive voice)

We could fill this position now or hire someone next year. (active voice + active voice)

We could fill this position now or next year.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid cliches

We talked until early in the morning, but we just couldn't see eye to eye on where to go for dinner.



Ways to write concisely



Avoid cliches

We talked until early in the morning, but we just **couldn't see eye to eye** on where to go for dinner.

We talked until early in the morning, but we just **agree** on where to go for dinner.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid cliches

In rural areas doctors are so few and far between that even though the doctors work like dogs, the children do not get adequate medical care.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid cliches

In rural areas doctors are so **few and far between** that even though the doctors **work like dogs**, the children do not get adequate medical care.

In rural areas doctors are so **rare** that even though the doctors **work hard**, the children do not get adequate medical care.

Ways to write concisely



Avoid cliches

In a crisis, Jing is cool, calm and collected, so we know that he will be an effective nurse in the ER.



Ways to write concisely



Avoid cliches

In a crisis, Jing is **cool, calm and collected**, so we know that he will be an effective nurse in the ER.

In a crisis, Jing is **calm**, so we know that he will be an effective nurse in the ER.

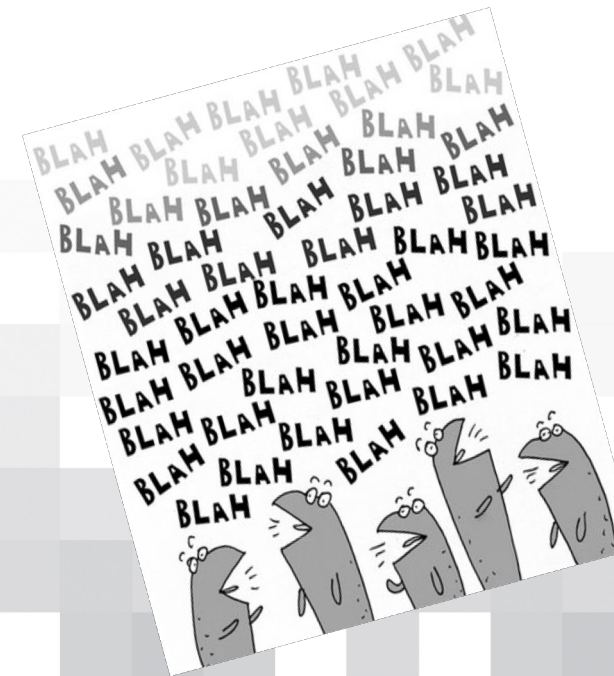
Task



Writing concisely



Trouble is caused when employees disobey rules that have been established for the safety of all. (15 words)



Writing concisely



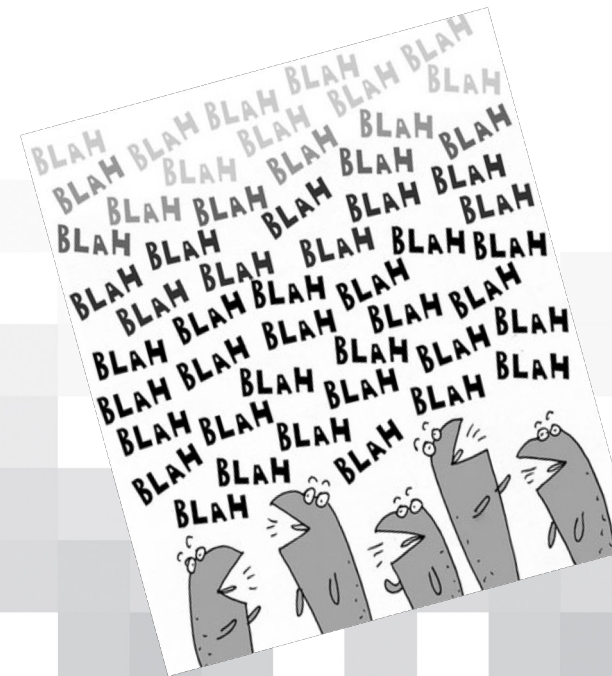
Employees cause trouble when they disobey safety rules. (8 words)



Writing concisely



This essay will attempt to examine the work of Rothe (2005), as well as the work of Peterson (2005), comparing and contrasting these positive views on HRC theory with the opposing views of Smith (2006). (35 words)



Writing concisely



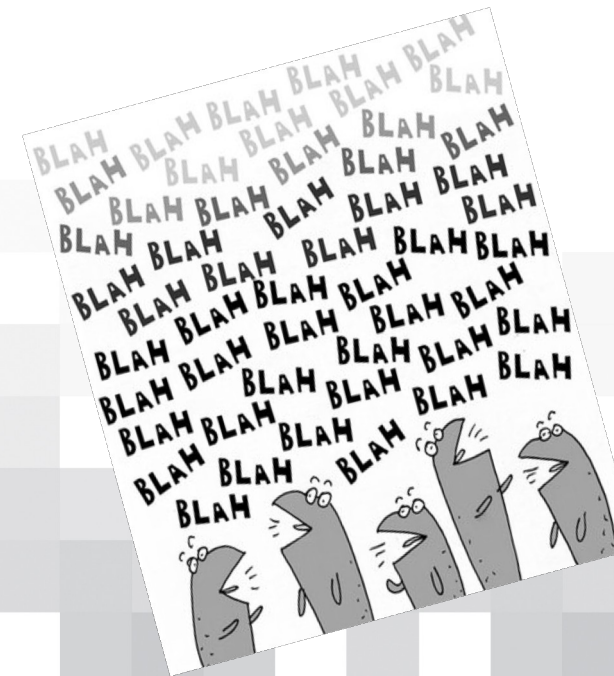
This essay will examine the work of Rothe (2005) and Peterson (2005), before contrasting their views with Smith (2006). (19 words)



Writing concisely



It is expected that the new restructuring will be announced by the board of managers within the next few days. (20 words)



Writing concisely



The board of managers will announce the restructuring soon. (9 words)

OR

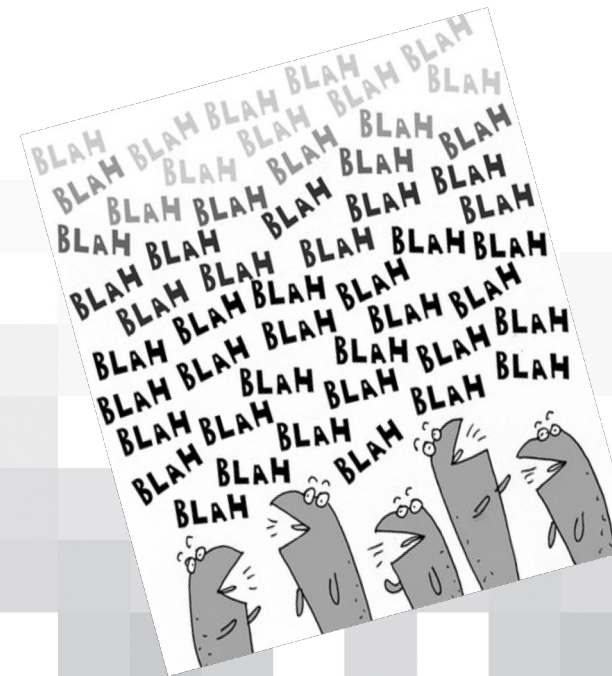
The board of managers is expected to announce the restructuring soon. (11 words)



Writing concisely



Some people passionately believe in Brexit, while other people are against it: there is much disagreement on this subject. (19 words)



Writing concisely



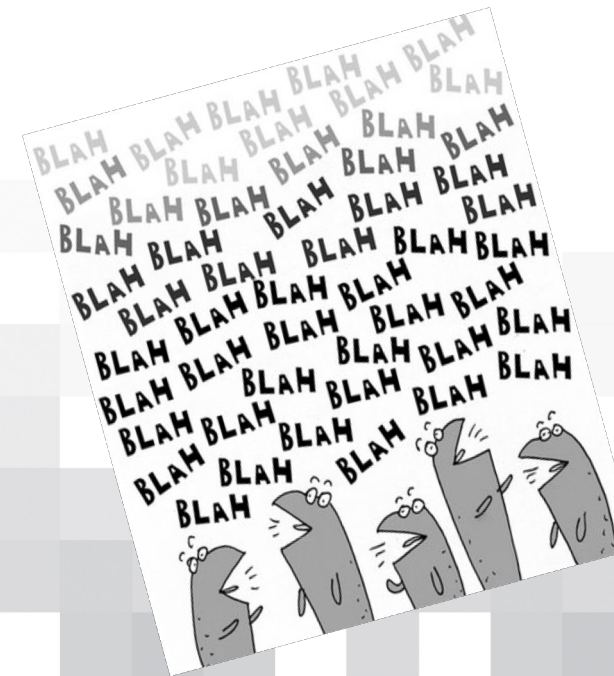
Brexit is a highly controversial issue. (6 words)



Writing concisely



The data is represented in the bar chart (Figure 3.4) below. (9 words)



Writing concisely



The data is represented in Figure 3.4. (6 words)

OR

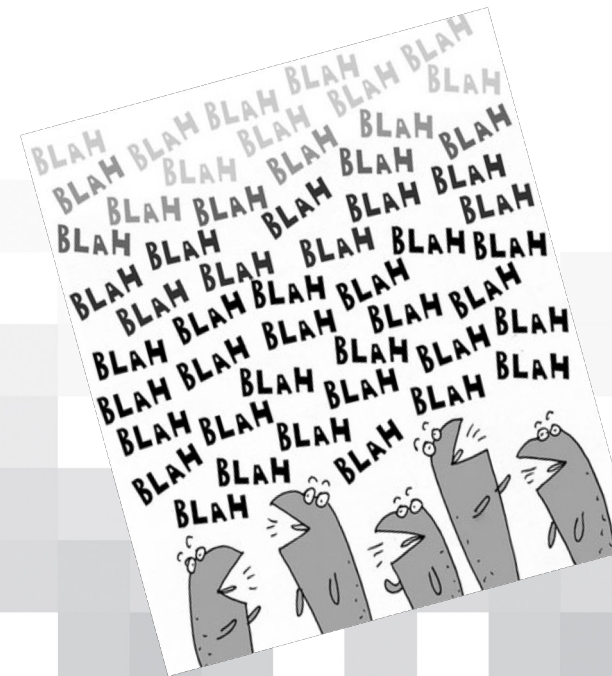
Figure 3.4 represents the data. (4 words)



Writing concisely



In spite of the fact that in-house training programmes can be very easily organised by most Human Resource managers, there are often few such programmes in major companies. (28 words)



Writing concisely



Although most Human Resource managers can easily organise in-house training programmes, there are often few such programmes in major companies. (20 words)



Writing concisely



A great number of people feel that people who work for the government need to be able to communicate with the public in a more effective way. (27 words)



Writing concisely



Many people feel that government employees need to communicate better with the public. (13 words)



Writing concisely

In order to answer the question, it is necessary for me to research this topic further. (16 words)



Writing concisely



To answer the question, I need to research this topic further. (11 words)



Writing concisely



Could you recommend to us someone in the area who works as a contractor? (14 words)



Writing concisely



Could you recommend a local contractor? (6 words)



Writing concisely



The problem was addressed at our meeting that we have every week. (12 words)



Writing concisely



We addressed the problem at our weekly meeting. (8 words)



Writing concisely

Carlos speaks English fluently, and can also speak Portuguese at an intermediate level, and in addition he is capable of conversing in German. (23 words)



Writing concisely



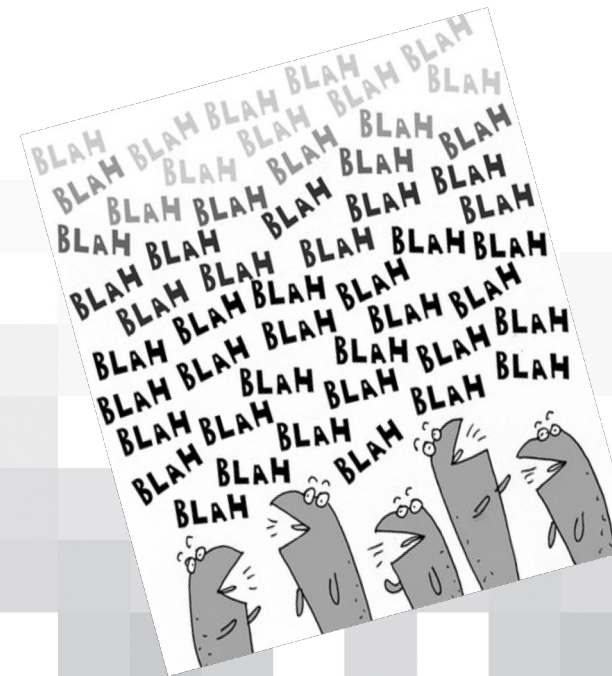
Carlos speaks fluent English, intermediate Portuguese, and conversational German. (9 words)



Writing concisely



Some people passionately believe in Brexit, while other people are passionately against it: there is much disagreement on this subject. (18 words)



Writing concisely



Brexit is controversial. (3 words)

OR

Brexit is highly controversial. (4 words)



Original: 110 Words



International relations are an extremely important and essential aspect of citizenship in a global society. As the world is becoming smaller and smaller through the ever expanding and ubiquitous use of communication technology, rapid air transportation and the working of the complex international economy, the value of peaceful, cooperative and harmonious relationships between the nations on this planet is becoming increasingly important. When the whole international community confronts nuclear weapons proliferation, terrorism, poverty, climate change and epidemic diseases (e.g. AIDS) it is necessary for national interests to obtain multilateral agreements and pursue actions to deal with threats, challenges or problems that cannot be dealt with effectively at the unilateral level.

International relations are an extremely important ~~and essential~~ aspect of **global citizenship** ~~citizenship in a global society~~. As the world **shrinks** ~~is becoming smaller and smaller~~ through the **ever** ~~expanding and~~ ubiquitous use of communication technology, **rapid** air transportation and the **working** ~~of the~~ complex international economy, the value of **peaceful, cooperative and** harmonious relationships between **the** nations ~~on this planet~~ is becoming increasingly important. When the **whole** international community confronts nuclear weapons proliferation, terrorism, poverty, climate change and epidemics **diseases (e.g. AIDS)** it is necessary for national interests to obtain multilateral agreements and pursue actions to deal with **threats,** challenges **or** **problems** that cannot be dealt with effectively **unilaterally** ~~at the unilateral level~~.

Edited: 77 Words



International relations are an extremely important aspect of global citizenship. As the world shrinks through the ubiquitous use of communication technology, air transportation and the complex international economy, the value of harmonious relationships between nations is becoming increasingly important. When the international community confronts nuclear weapons proliferation, terrorism, poverty, climate change and epidemics it is necessary for national interests to obtain multilateral agreements and pursue actions to deal with challenges that cannot be dealt with effectively unilaterally.

Edit + Self Paraphrase: 48 words.



International relations are an extremely important aspect of global citizenship. Due to globalisation, the value of harmonious relationships between nations is increasingly important. When the international community confronts global problems like climate change and terrorism nations must obtain multilateral agreements and pursue actions to deal with multi-lateral challenges.